Glacier cold-room controller GCC-3, hardware revision B: mandatory firmware update to v3.2.1

Product family	Glacier cold rooms (controller sub-assembly)
Affected part	Controller GCC-3-HWB (GCC-3 hardware revision B)
Change class	Class A - mandatory field action, food safety relevant
Originator	Siri Haugland, Controls Engineering Lead
Change requested by	Quality, following customer escalation (temperature excursion)
Effectivity (production)	Immediate. All GCC-3-HWB controllers ship with v3.2.1 from 2026-W04
Related notices	ECN-2025-014 (PR-400 start capacitor)

1. Reason for change

Firmware versions 3.1.0 to 3.1.4 on controller hardware revision B contain a fault in the defrost scheduler. After a power interruption the controller can lose the defrost schedule and skip defrost cycles until it is restarted. The evaporator ices over and the room temperature drifts upward over 24 to 72 hours.

The fault was found after a customer escalation in December 2025, when a chilled storage room in a distribution centre exceeded 8 °C for 31 hours and stock was destroyed. Investigation showed the room was served by a Polar PR-400 rack that had restarted after a C1 start fault (see ECN-2025-014). Any power interruption can trigger the fault, but rack restarts make it more frequent.

2. Description of change

Firmware v3.2.1 rewrites the defrost schedule to non-volatile memory and adds a watchdog that forces a defrost if none has run for 12 hours. No hardware change. Controller hardware revision A (GCC-3-HWA) runs firmware 2.x and is not affected. Controller GCC-4 is not affected.

Controller	Firmware in field	Affected	Action
GCC-3-HWA	2.4 to 2.7	No	None
GCC-3-HWB	3.0.x	No	Update at next visit (recommended)
GCC-3-HWB	3.1.0 to 3.1.4	Yes	Mandatory update to 3.2.1
GCC-4	4.x	No	None

3. Affected items

All cold rooms fitted with a GCC-3-HWB controller running firmware 3.1.0 to 3.1.4. This notice does not list cold room models or serial numbers, because the controller is fitted by configuration, not by model. Use the as-built bill of material in ERP to find which units carry GCC-3-HWB.

For guidance only: GCC-3-HWB was fitted as standard to Glacier GC-M and GC-L rooms built from September 2024. GC-S rooms normally carry GCC-3-HWA, but some received a GCC-3-HWB as a service replacement after a controller failure. Those are recorded only as a part replaced on the service ticket, not in the as-built bill of material.

Controller boards are manufactured for Nordvik by Halden Controls AS. Firmware 3.1.x was loaded by Halden before shipment, so the firmware version cannot be inferred from the cold room build date alone.

4. Field action

Situation	Action	Deadline
Room connected to the NordLink remote gateway	Remote firmware push by Service Operations. Confirm version 3.2.1 in NordLink.	28 Feb 2026
Room not connected	Site visit. Update via service port with tool NST-7.	Within 60 days of this notice
Food retail and food distribution customers	Written customer notification before the update, using template CN-2026-01. Account manager to be copied.	Within 10 working days

5. Service instructions

Use activity code FW-003. Record the firmware version found and the version installed on the work order. Where the site also has a PR-400 rack inside the ECN-2025-014 range that has not yet been retrofitted, carry out RET-014 on the same visit.

Labour for FW-003 is booked to the warranty cost centre WC-ENG-2026 for all customers, including those with a service contract.

6. Cost and warranty

Estimated population: 900 to 1,100 controllers, of which roughly 55% are connected to NordLink. Site visit cost EUR 150 to 280 depending on country. Legal is assessing the December 2025 stock loss claim separately (reference LG-2025-044); do not discuss liability with the customer.

7. References

ECN-2025-014 Rev B; customer escalation ESC-2025-118; Halden Controls release note HC-FW-3.2.1; customer notification template CN-2026-01; legal reference LG-2025-044.

Approvals

Role	Name	Signed	Date
Controls Engineering	Siri Haugland	Signed	19 Jan 2026
Quality	Tomas Hrubec	Signed	19 Jan 2026
Service Operations	Marte Lien	Signed	20 Jan 2026
Legal	Kari Nordahl	Signed	20 Jan 2026